

Harry Potter and the Cursed Child- Scorpius

SCORPIUS:

You think I want to just ignore everything that's happened? The world has gone crazy, haven't you noticed?

Ron's gone strange. Hermione's a professor, it's all wrong, and Rose doesn't exist.

Because of what we did, Rose wasn't even born. Do you remember being told about the Triwizard Tournament Yule Ball? All four Triwizard champions took a partner. Your dad took Parvati

Patil, Viktor Krum took Hermione and Ron got jealous and behaved like a prat...only he didn't. I found Rita Skeeter's book about them. And it's very different.

Ron took Hermione to the ball - as friends- and they danced in a friendly way, and it was nice, and then he danced with Padma Patil and that was nicer, and they started dating, and he changed a bit, and then **they** got married and meanwhile Hermione became a —

Hermione was supposed to go to that ball with Krum, but do you know why she didn't? Because she had suspicions the two strange Durmstrang boys she met before the first task were somehow involved in the disappearance of Cedric's wand. She believed we — under Viktor's orders — cost Cedric the first task . . .

And without Krum, Ron never got jealous and that jealousy was all-important and so Ron and Hermione stayed very good friends but never fell in love — never got married — never had Rose.

Have you heard me, Albus? This is bigger than you and your dad.

Professor Croaker's law — the furthest someone can go back in time without the possibility of serious harm to the traveller or time itself is five hours. And we went back years. The smallest moment, the smallest change, it creates ripples. And we — we've created really bad ripples.

Find me by Olwen Wymark:

Verity

Verity:

I love to swim. I'm happy swimming. I'm free. I'm the best swimmer in the class. Miss said so, she said, "Verity, you're the best swimmer in the class," she did. I'm the best swimmer in England. I'm the best swimmer in the world. I'm the best swimmer in the whole universe.

You're safe in water, safe as safe.

When I grow up I'm going to be an Olympic champion. Verity Taylor, gold medallist. I'll be on television and I'll make a speech and everyone will cheer and clap and all of the little children will ask for my autograph. And I'll meet the Queen, and the sun will be shining on my gold medal and on her gold crown, and she'll shake my hand. She'll love me, everyone will love me!

One day I'll swim the English Channel. On and on I'll go until I get to France! I'll be strong and I won't be scared of the waves and the sharks. And my Dad'll be in the boat beside me, feeding me sandwiches and lemonade. He'll say 'Come on Verity, you can do it!' And I will. I'll go on and on and on.

When I am 'm in bed at night I dream about swimming. I'm swimming in the sea and I'm riding in the foam of the waves, and I wave back at all the people in the boats and they wave back.

Sometimes I dream I'm swimming all by myself in a lake high up in the mountains. I'm all alone except for the birds and the fishes. Don't be afraid of the snakes, they're only water snakes. They won't hurt you! It's my lake, Verity Lake in the Verity Mountains.

I Don't Want to Talk About it by Bradley Hayward

CHELSEA.

I dropped an egg roll in my grandpa's casket- I can explain.

People like to bring food when someone dies, you know. They don't know what to say, so they stuff their faces instead. Well, that's what my grandpa's funeral was like. An all-you-can-eat buffet. I even caught my Auntie Joan sneaking butter packets into her purse.

Anyway, my Uncle Pete is married to this Asian lady named Ming. She's, like, super pretty. I wish I was that pretty. And I swear, she makes the best egg rolls ever. Better than the ones you get at the mall, even. Well, she brought a pile of her famous egg rolls to the funeral and everyone clumped up at her end of the buffet. Nobody wanted the salmon salad sandwiches at the other end. The crusts might have been cut off, but salmon salad is still salmon salad. Yuck!

So there I was at the front of the church, standing in line to say good-bye to Grandpa. I don't know why they left the casket open. It's not like he needed to breathe or anything. Finally, my turn came to pay my respects, but I didn't know what to say. I just leaned in and stared at his face for a while. His gray whiskers were caked with pink foundation. It was kinda creepy, but I didn't say anything because everyone else thought he looked so peaceful. I could feel the line of people nudging me forward, so I just said the first thing that came to mind. "Try an egg roll," I said. "They're delicious!" And then I dropped one in next to him.

Weird, I know—spending eternity with an egg roll. But somehow it felt like the right thing to do.

A Monster Calls

Yew Tree:

Who am I? Who am I?!

I am the ancient yew tree! And I have as many names as there are years to time itself!

I am Herne the Hunter! I am the eternal Green Man!

I am the spine on which mountains hang! I am the tears that rivers cry! I am the wolf that kills the stag, the spider that kills the fly!

I am the snake of the world devouring its own tail! I am everything untamed and untameable! I am this wild earth, come for you, Conor O'Malley.

I do not often come walking, boy — only for matters of life and death. I will be listened to!

What do I want with you?

Here is what will happen, Conor O'Malley. I will come to you again on further nights. And I will tell you three stories — three tales from when I walked before.

Stories are the wildest things of all! Stories chase and bite and hunt. And when I have finished my three stories, you will tell me a fourth. And it will be the truth.

Your truth — the one you hide, Conor O'Malley — the thing you are most afraid of.

You will tell the truth, for that is why you called me.

“Twelve Years Wise” By Gabriel Davis

GRACE

Yes, I'm only twelve. I don't know everything you do. But I need you to listen to me. Because I think I know something here...

I know when you yell at mom it's usually because you think you're right and she's wrong. But if mom's crying because you're yelling then I think you're even more wrong.

I know there must be a better way to make your point than to stick mom with it until she cries. Maybe you could soften your point... like I did with Jackie...

I didn't tell you or mom this but... Jackie took my favorite dress without asking. The one I was going to wear on my first day back at school. She went to a sleepover and got grape soda all over it. It's ruined!

I wanted to yell at her. To tell her right in front of you and mom how insensitive she was and how she's a bad sister because she didn't think of me at all... But the last time I did that she didn't talk to me for a week...

No, instead I downloaded that funny movie she was dying to see and we watched it and laughed, and then when we were both really happy together, I told her quietly, privately about how excited I'd been to wear the dress my first day back at school.

She said I was just telling her to make her feel bad. I said I was just telling her because I wanted her to know how I felt.

And she said... she kinda knew, but not how MUCH it mattered to me.

So when she finally apologized, I knew it was real and not because you or mom made her. But because she loves me.

So I'm saying... maybe instead of yelling at mom when she gets home... maybe you should take her on a really nice date instead.

Do you want Mom to be nicer to you... Or do you just want to be “right”?

Spaghetti Bolognese (by Alexander Lee-Rekers)

SAM:

Let me guess: you're here to find out what happened. You look at me, Sam Barber, and wonder how the heck a kid like him could ever mess up dating a girl as amazing as Hannah Benson...

Do you like cooking? I love cooking. It's, like, one of my favourite hobbies—which I know is weird for somebody my age. The best thing I cook is my Spaghetti Bolognese. I let it simmer for hours so it reduces to this beautiful, sweet, delicious, tomato-ey sauce- What's this got to do with Hannah? I'm getting to that.

Hannah and I went on three dates. The first date was more like a study session at the library. I'd had a crush on her since forever and I asked her if she wanted to see a movie. For date three, mum suggested I invite her over for dinner and cook. She says women love a man who can cook.

I started on my greatest-ever pot of Spaghetti Bolognese: I minced the garlic, I browned the meat, bought really good tinned tomatoes from the shops—like, fancy ones from Italy. I even remembered to take the bay leaves out before they got bitter.

Hannah arrived at six o'clock. Dinner was on the table. I watched her take her first bite ... and nothing. No reaction, no smile, no eyes closed going "mmmm". Nothing! She just chomped away silently until her bowl was empty.

The next day, at school, I asked her how she liked the meal. She said it was nice. I asked her about the flavours, about how the pasta was cooked. She didn't even try the garlic bread I'd made!

"I'm just not that into food, Sam."

And in that moment ... something shifted. Mum says this happens, sometimes. People get to know each other and discover that they're different. She wasn't the one for me, and that's okay. I know the one for me is out there. Maybe in Italy?

GIRLS LIKE THAT: Evan Placey

Girl with shoulder pads:

I have only worked at Pierce, Richards and Stanley for a week.

My mother is nervous. They don't normally take on girls as young as me, but I want to be a lawyer, so my mum has made some calls and got me this after-school gig a couple hours a week.

I am what you call a 'runner'. From 4pm to 6 p.m. I run between floors delivering mail, coffee, photocopies, memos and faxes from other floors.

I even bought a new outfit, just for work. How cool am I?

The female employees tell me to stay out of Mr Stanley's way, but today I had these papers I gotta deliver to Mr Stanley's secretary. Only she's on break, so I knock on his door.

The first thing he says is: 'That's a pretty outfit'.

See, it's important to dress for success. That's what my mum says. I don't tell him this, obviously. I just say: 'Thank you sir'.

As I'm handing him his papers, he puts his hand on my waist and he says: 'What an efficient young woman you are. You'll be put to good use here'.

'I want to be a lawyer, sir'. And his hand has subtly slid further down my waist.

'Well, this will certainly be a good experience for you then', he says

'I thought so too,' I tell him. 'But I'm not so sure. See, you're supposed to be this amazing lawyer, but you seem not to know anything about employment law.'

He doesn't understand.

'See, this, right here, would be considered sexual harassment in the workplace. And you seem not to know that!

DAGS BY DEBRA OSWALD

GILLIAN:

All right. I'm going to admit something I never thought I'd admit to anyone, ever...

I've got a crush on Adam. Head over heels. Uncontrollable passion, etcetera.

Unrequited passion, of course.

I know every girl at school except Monica is in love with him. I know he'd never go for a dag like me. I know it's hopeless. I know all that. But I can't help it.

Just thinking he might look at me, my heart starts pounding like mad. And then I worry about whether he can tell my heart's going crazy, and I have to act really cool. This crush – it's like a disease.

Do you know – oh, I'm almost too embarrassed to admit this – Adam misses the bus sometimes. 'Cos he's chatting up some girl or something. And do you know what I do? I get off the bus after one stop and walk back to school, so I can hang round the bus stop hoping he'll turn up. Just so I can ride on the same bus with him.

Isn't that the most pathetic thing you've ever heard? I'm crazy.

I can lie here for hours thinking about him. Writing these movies in my head where Adam and me are the stars. I try to imagine how he'd notice me and fall hopelessly in love with me and all that. He discovers that I was this really fascinating woman all along. Far more interesting than all those silly girls at school.

Frank and Ferdinand

Flora

Once upon a time, a certain village was overrun with rats, and a mysterious man appeared, wearing a scarf - or was it a coat?- of several colours, and he claimed to be a rat-catcher, and he promised that for a certain sum, he would rid the town of the rats.

The Mayor agreed, and from his pocket the man produced a recorder-or perhaps a pipe-I don't remember, and when he played the rats followed him into the river, where they drowned.

Now rat-free, the Mayor of the town, in New Zealand- or was it China?- decided not to pay the piper, and the piper left angry. But on the 26th of June, or 22nd of July, he returned, now dressed even more colourfully, with a white feather in his hat- a black-and-white feather, which caused him to be called pied. And he played his pipe, and this time children followed and disappeared into a cave in the flattened hills that used to exist where the church now stands. That's the truth; ask the Elders.

One hundred and twenty-nine children were lost that day, though some say some were left behind.

And the moral is, don't talk to strangers, keep promises and pay your debts.

Many cheerful songs have been written to memorialise the lost children, and the village is now pure and happy and somewhat rich.

Tourists with visitor passes come to see the cave which has been constructed at the end of the High Street, and they recite the poems, and sing the songs, and photograph the statue outside the delicious bakery of the colourful piper smiling his come hither smile.

Romeo and Juliet by William Shakespeare

Juliet:

O Romeo, Romeo, wherefore art thou Romeo?

Deny thy father and refuse thy name.

Or if thou wilt not, be but sworn my love

And I'll no longer be a Capulet.

'Tis but thy name that is my enemy:

Thou art thyself, though not a Montague.

What's Montague? It is nor hand nor foot

Nor arm nor face nor any other part

Belonging to a man. O be some other name.

What's in a name? That which we call a rose

By any other name would smell as sweet;

So Romeo would, were he not Romeo call'd,

Retain that dear perfection which he owes

Without that title. Romeo, doff thy name,

And for that name, which is no part of thee,

Take all myself.

Age Is Revolting by Abi Zakarian

Barney:

Loads of old people have that disease thing that makes them forget – but when they sing songs from like ‘the old times’ they know all the words.

My grandad is like that; he don’t know who I am most times. Calls me Albert.

*A pause, then **Barney** continues.*

We go see him every Sunday afternoon. He’s in this...place.

Mum’s talking and talking: about the weather, about Dad being useless, about the new Netflix thing she’s not even watching. And Grandad . . . I know he’s as bored as me because every now and then he’ll laugh really loudly like she’s just told a good joke, even though she’s only rambling on about hot flushes and that.

Sometimes his eyes fix on me; really laser-focused, not faraway like usual, and he’ll go:

“It’s a thousand yards to escape, Albert. Nothing more. Nothing less. I tell you: a thousand yards.”

And Mum will say:

“This is Barney, Dad. Barney. Not Albert. Remember?” And she looks sad then.

Grandad glares at her, shakes his head like she’s proper lost it and says:

“He’ll always be Albert to me!”

I googled ‘a thousand yards’. Apparently it’s a thing from the war – ‘The Thousand Yard Stare’. Like a hundred years ago, when soldiers saw so much horror and death they just sort of shut down their brains and stared into the distance to protect themselves from seeing any more –

“ A thousand yards, Albert; that’s all. A thousand yards’ escape before I’m home.”

Orchestra by Charlie Josephine

3rd Trumpet:

Miss asked me to stay behind one day, after rehearsals. Because she'd noticed that I didn't look very happy, and she asked me if everything was OK.

So suddenly I'm like, being really honest, about feeling stressed that I'm not good enough, and even though I'm practising all the time, it's like- I keep making these stupid mistakes, and I could be really good, and something's holding me back.

And suddenly, she asks me, 'What does music feel like?'

"I... I dunno" I say.

"Yes you do . . . go on".

"No, miss, I don't."

"Stop saying you don't because you're embarrassed. Just take a breath, and answer the question."

And I'm like:

"erm.. I dunno I, kind of hear it more than feel it. Like, like the vibration. I dunno...my mouth feels it! And I guess, yeah, my fingers feel the pressure on the valves as I press them down or - actually, my whole body feels it! Like my ribs, they like expand out, and open, like wings- yeah, like wings!

And my stomach rises and falls, and my arms and my legs ache and it's like I can feel the floor. The resonance of the whole orchestra buzzing through my feet on the floor. It rises up my legs, up my back, up my neck and through my skull- like this golden buzzing golden sound that flies up and out of me. It comes through me, and when I'm open it flows out- Oh my Gosh, that's it! I just have to focus on being open! My job is to stay open!"

And she just smiles. And I smile.

"Thanks, Miss."

Kiss/ Marry/ Push off a Cliff by Josh Azouz

Carl:

I first went camping with my dad. Dad had a two-man tent, but I got it into my head I'd sleep on my own. My mum said "are you sure?" I was only nine or something so it would have been legit to camp with Dad.

The weekend before we went, I practised putting up my tent in the garden. I didn't want my older cousins mugging me off and my dad pulling rank and forcing me to share.

And then the day arrives, and my mum is fussing loads. She's trying to pack my owl teddy. But I put my foot down on that one. You can't take an owl teddy on a camping trip with men. Anyway, we get to the site. I set up my tent. It looks fab! The first night – no problem. I wake up feeling like a champion. But the second night is a different story.

A panther had escaped from the local zoo, and mauled a man, to the point where this man was in hospital fighting for his life. My dad begged me to come and stay in his tent, but I was like "nah, I can handle some cat."

So there's nine-year-old me in the tent, my toes so cold I've stuck them in my beanie, holding myself in the foetus position, and the wind- I swear the wind is going to blow me away! And then I realise I haven't locked the tent. I've zipped up the inside but not the outside, and the inside door is a sheer type of material – any passing panther will see a man cub on a plate!

I start to pray. I think this is how I'm gonna die. What a fool. Why didn't I share with my dad? He's six foot four and sleeps with a hunting knife!

Macbeth- William Shakespeare

Macbeth:

Is this a dagger which I see before me,
The handle toward my hand?
Come, let me clutch thee.

I have thee not, and yet I see thee still.
Art thou not, fatal vision, sensible to feeling as to sight?
Or art thou but A dagger of the mind,
A false creation,
Proceeding from the heat-oppressèd brain?

I see thee yet,
In form as palpable as this which now I draw.
Thou marshall'st me the way that I was going,
And such an instrument I was to use.

Mine eyes are made the fools o' th' other senses,
Or else worth all the rest.

I see thee still,
And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood,
Which was not so before.

There's no such thing.
It is the bloody business which informs thus to mine eyes.

Now o'er the one half-world
Nature seems dead, and wicked dreams abuse the curtained sleep.

Thou sure and firm-set earth,
Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear
Thy very stones prate of my whereabouts,
And take the present horror from the time,
Which now suits with it.

While I threat, he lives.

I go, and it is done; the bell invites me.

Hear it not, Duncan; for it is a knell
That summons thee to heaven or to hell.

Macbeth- William Shakespeare

LADY MACBETH

Here's a spot.

Out, damned spot, out, I say!

One. Two. Why then, 'tis time to do 't.

Hell is murky. Fie, my lord, fie, a soldier and afeard?

What need we fear who knows it, when none can call our power to account?

Yet who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?

The Thane of Fife had a wife. Where is she now?

What, will these hands ne'er be clean? No more o' that, my lord, no more o' that. You mar all with this starting.

Here's the smell of the blood still. All the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand. O, O, O!

Wash your hands. Put on your nightgown. Look not so pale. I tell you yet again, Banquo's buried; he cannot come out on 's grave.

To bed, to bed. There's knocking at the gate.

Come, come, come, come. Give me your hand. What's done cannot be undone.

To bed, to bed, to bed....

Macbeth- William Shakespeare

Lady Macbeth:

The raven himself is hoarse
That croaks the fatal entrance of Duncan
Under my battlements. Come, you spirits
That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here,
And fill me from the crown to the toe top-full
Of direst cruelty! make thick my blood;
Stop up the access and passage to remorse,
That no compunctious visitings of nature
Shake my fell purpose, nor keep peace between
The effect and it! Come to my woman's breasts,
And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers,
Wherever in your sightless substances
You wait on nature's mischief! Come, thick night,
And pall thee in the dunnest smoke of hell,
That my keen knife see not the wound it makes,
Nor heaven peep through the blanket of the dark,
To cry 'Hold, hold!'

Man in Motion by Jan Mark

Lloyd:

There's this boy I know, Keith Mainwaring; I met him down at American football practice, and we were friends right off, and his dad gives me a lift home afterwards. He's really friendly ... but he says things- they both do.... Racist things. All the time, like without thinking. Every time they see somebody Asian, they say something ... and I don't say anything. I don't know what to say.

I keep thinking they don't really mean it, especially Keith, because he's nice, really- I mean, otherwise he's nice. He rings up and asks how I am, and pays for my lunch and that. I really like him, except for the things he says....

That's why I've stopped going to practices; to avoid him. I don't think he really means it, I think it's just because of what his dad says.

It's funny ... odd ... calling somebody a racist. It doesn't sound real. We have this lesson at school, Social Awareness Studies, only we call it Isms. Because that's what it is, all the time; sexism, racism, feminism. And last week we had this discussion on racism; somebody brought in a cutting from a newspaper, and everyone said how awful it was, only we've got these two girls in our class, Farida and Farzana, and nobody thought about them. They just sat there, and nobody took any notice or asked them what they thought. I mean, they never say much anyway, but that wasn't the point. Racism's just something half of us argue about while the other half do our homework. It's just a word. It doesn't mean anything, because it doesn't happen to us.... Racism is just something on the news....But it's not for me. Not any more.

Last Day of School by Ian McWethy

Brian is fed up with his best friend Dave for talking about asking out a girl but never actually doing anything. He is in love with Madison Montgomery.

Brian:

I'm just...I guess I'm just having a hard time Dave. A hard time understanding why you can't understand why I might be a bit sceptical about **you**- Dave McDonald- asking out Madison Montgomery out on a date.

Can you not think of why I might be a tad bit cautious? HmMMM? Can you really not? ...

Dave... I have been listening to you talk about Madison for four years now. Four years Dave! And throughout those four years I supported you. I did. I supported you when, as a freshman, you told me your locker was next to the most beautiful girl you'd ever seen and that you wanted to ask her out and that nothing was gonna stop you! And then sophomore year, when you said you were going to ask Madison to homecoming, because it was your destiny! Your destiny **you** said! But did you ask her out? No. You didn't. Because you swore that you were coming down with mono! Not that you had any symptoms of mono. You clearly just chickened out!

Brian takes a deep breath.

Look the point is, it seems like every six months you have some sort of epiphany about how now is the "right time" to ask Madison out. And then every time you go to ask her out, you get scared and make up some excuse. You have piano practice, or she's a Gemini, or you heard a weird rumor that she "will only date 18 year-olds." And now you're telling me that this time...this time you're actually gonna do it. This time it's different?! Is that what you're telling me?!

I just can't listen to you do this again! Okay! So! Dave! Yes, I am being a good friend by sitting here and not encouraging you.

Lord of the Flies by William Golding

Ralph:

How did things end up like this? I mean, what is wrong with people? Let's go to the other side of the island to hunt and have fun...and die here on this silly island!? Doesn't anyone care about getting rescued?! The fire should always be the number one priority! If it wasn't for Jack, I would probably be at home right now...

My hair... it's so long... I mean, I can barely see. And I can barely get my fingers through it. My clothes... they're like cardboard. The salt... it's everywhere. Look at my nails. I would do anything for a bar of soap... anything just to have a bath. Look at my face... look at me! I probably look like one of Jack's hunters with all this dirt. Stupid face painting...as if they think it actually helped them catch that boar. I could be home right now. I could off this island with mom and dad and...

Mom always told me that sometimes things are better left unsaid and I have tried. I have tried to reason with him. I don't understand. I was voted chief fair and square. He always says I am afraid and I am sometimes. But who wouldn't be? Even Jack looked scared when he ran down that mountain. But of course, he will never admit that. What did I ever do to Jack? Why do you hate me, Jack?

I just wanted to work together, get things done on this island, and do everything we can to be rescued. But he doesn't seem to care.

Whistle Down the Wind (by Mary Hayley Bell)

Swallow:

Can you keep a secret? A really big secret? You've got to hold up your hand and do the 'See this wet' routine:

"See this wet, see this dry,
Cut my throat if I tell a lie..."

This is a great and fabulous secret known to none but those within these walls. You have to join a society to be allowed to know the secret, and all who know must swear never to divulge.

Will you absolutely swear?

If you ever breathe a word, something ghastly will happen to you...

Alright... That man is Jesus... We have proof. We were in here messing about. There was a sort of knock on the door and I opened it. He stood there smiling weakly at us, and said, 'Knock on the door and it shall be opened unto you'... And I said, 'Who are you?' and he staggered round this place, not answering at once, and then suddenly said, rather loud: 'JESUS'... just like that...

His legs were all cut, wounds on the palms of his hands and his boots and socks crammed with mud.

I asked Him if I should get someone and He said 'Don't tell them I'm here, not till I've recovered'... He's ill... too ill to talk. He's been asleep for six hours!... In the daytime!...

The grown-ups may not believe... suppose they try and take Him away... after all they did last time... But there's hundreds of children around here and if the grown-ups try to take Him away again, we'll defend Him... Hundreds of us!

Acting Class by M. Ramirez.

Angelique:

I took an acting class and the teacher was this weird creepy guy who was going bald and who wore tight pants and didn't pronounce my name right ONCE.

ANGELIQUE. My name is ANGEL-EEK. Not "Angelica," not "Angie"... Angelique. It's French for "Like an Angel" or "Born from Angels" or "Touched by an Angel"... something. I dunno. It doesn't matter.

He didn't get it right once. He made us do all these weird creepy breathing exercises and all I could think of the whole time is MY MOTHER IS NOT PAYING FOR YOU TO TEACH ME HOW TO BREATHE, WEIRD CREEPY BALD GUY WITH TIGHT PANTS... MY MOTHER IS PAYING YOU TO TEACH ME TO ACT. 'Cause that's what I'm good at. Acting. Like I'm really good at swimming and I paint too and my sister and I made State Jazz Ensemble but what I'm REALLY good at? Is acting.

"Breathe in"... "Hold"... "Breathe out"... "Feel your inner animal reaching through"...

Inner animal? Are you kidding?

I Google-d the guy when I got home. Whatever, I know it's weird, but I had to. I HAD to know what this guy's done that makes him so special. Know what this guy's done, this guy who's supposedly gonna teach me how to act? Three episodes of Ghost Hunter Deluxe and a deodorant commercial. DEODORANT? Is this a joke? What's this guy gonna teach me to do? NOT SWEAT?!

The Diary of Anne Frank by Albert Hackett & Frances Goodrich

Anne:

You know what I do when it seems as if I couldn't stand being cooped up for one more minute? I think myself out. I think myself on a walk in the park where I used to go with Pim. Where the jonquils and the crocus and the violets grow down the slopes.

You know the most wonderful part about thinking yourself out? You can have it any way you like. You can have roses and violets and chrysanthemums all blooming at the same time.

It's funny. I used to take it all for granted. And now I've gone crazy about everything to do with nature. Haven't you?

I wish you had a religion, Peter. Just to believe in something! When I think of all that's out there. The trees. And flowers. And seagulls. And the goodness of people we know, all risking their lives for us every day. When I think of these good things, I'm not afraid anymore.

We're not the only people who have had to suffer. There've always been people that've had to. Sometimes one race, sometimes another, and yet...I know it's terrible, trying to have any faith when people are doing such horrible things, but you know what I sometimes think? I think the world may be going through a phase, the way I was with Mother. It'll pass, maybe not for hundreds of years, but someday I still believe, in spite of everything, that people are really good at heart.

A Property of the Clan (by Nick Enright)

Jade:

I play the song for you...every time I come.

The paper said somebody nicked your flowers. People are really off. But they're planting a tree for you at the front of the school tomorrow at lunchtime. But you probably know that now. I bet you know a lot of things now. I

should have been there with you Trace. A few times that night I thought I might sneak out. I really wanted to. Mum was reading in her room and I was just watching TV, I could have just left it on, sneaked out, come and found you. But I didn't. And I keep thinking, if I had, would it have been different?

Nobody seems to say anything straight. All these rumours go round and I just want to yell out, "this is Tracey you're talking about! She was here last week – working at the Pizza Hut, going to netball, catching the ferry. She was one of us!"

I wish I kept them earrings.

I woke up that night, faces looking down at me. I should have known. When I went round your place on Sunday and I saw the cop cars – I should have realised. You were calling to me. That nightmare, it was you calling. The faces – they were guy's faces, and I knew them all. The cops came round our place too, Mum was spewing. They're going to interview everyone who was at the party. 70 kids they're gonna talk to. But no one can talk to you.

You can talk to me. Tracey – please talk to me.

Romeo and Juliet (by William Shakespeare)

Juliet:

Shall I speak ill of him that is my husband?

Ah, poor my lord, what tongue shall smooth thy name,

When I, thy three hours' wife, have mangled it?

But wherefore, villain, didst thou kill my cousin?

That villain cousin would have killed my husband.

Back, foolish tears, back to your native spring.

Your tributary drops belong to woe,

Which you, mistaking, offer up to joy.

My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain,

And Tybalt's dead, that would have slain my husband.

All this is comfort. Wherefore weep I then?

Some word there was, worser than Tybalt's death,

That murdered me. I would forget it fain,

But oh, it presses to my celebration,

Like damnèd guilty deeds to sinners' minds.

"Tybalt is dead, and Romeo banishèd."

Cool girls and Dungeons and Dragons (by Patrick Cullen)

Billy comes running up to his best friend to talk about a conversation he overheard between the girls in his class

Billy:

Andy! Dude! You are not going to believe what I just overheard!

Okay so, I am walking back from the library right, I just checked out the Dungeons and Dragons Monster Manual, I know you can get a PDF online but you know how I feel about books –

anyway! So – I am walking back out of the library right, and I see like Alicia and Breanna and Kylie all the ‘cool’ girls walking towards me and they’re like talking and laughing and stuff like that. So I do what any of us would do right? I hide!

I duck myself between a watercooler and a classroom door and a I turn to face the door like I am reading the class list on the front of it and they walk right on by! And as they’re going past I am ready for them to make fun of me or to like say something super witty and cutting but what I heard instead blew me away.

As they walked past I heard Kylie say ‘Yeah, like I am so sick of playing a Barbarian, I think I want to make a new character.’ and then Alicia said ‘No way babe! I love Torben the Barbarian, she’s amazing!’

(a beat)

Dude. The cool girls at our school are playing Dungeons and Dragons. The cool girls at OUR SCHOOL are playing Dungeons and Dragons! I wonder if they need a halfling wizard?

The Adventures Of Huckleberry Finn

Huck:

Well, I got a good going-over in the morning from old Miss Watson on account of my clothes; but the widow she didn't scold, but only cleaned off the grease and clay, and looked so sorry that I thought I would behave awhile if I could.

Then Miss Watson she took me in the closet and prayed, but nothing come of it. She told me to pray every day, and whatever I asked for I would get it. But it warn't so. I tried it.

Once I got a fish-line, but no hooks. It warn't any good to me without hooks. I tried for the hooks three or four times, but somehow I couldn't make it work. By and by, one day, I asked Miss Watson to try for me, but she said I was a fool. She never told me why.

I set down one time back in the woods, and had a long think about it. I says to myself, "if a body can get anything they pray for, why don't Deacon Winn get back the money he lost on pork? Why can't the widow get back her silver snuffbox that was stole? Why can't Miss Watson fat up?" "No", says I to my self, "there ain't nothing in it".

I went and told the widow about it, and she said the thing somebody could get by praying was "spiritual gifts." This was too much for me, but she told me what she meant—I must help other people, and do everything I could for other people, and look out for them all the time, and never think about myself. This was including Miss Watson, as I took it.

I went out in the woods and turned it over in my mind a long time, but I couldn't see no advantage about it—except for the other people; so at last I reckoned I wouldn't worry about it any more, but just let it go.

Fences (August Wilson)

Cory:

I live here too! I ain't scared of you. I was walking by you to go into the house cause you sitting on the steps drunk, singing to yourself. I ain't got to say excuse me to you. You don't count around here any more. Now why don't you just get out my way.

You talking about what you did for me... what'd you ever give me? You ain't never gave me nothing. You ain't never done nothing but hold me back. Afraid I was gonna be better than you. All you ever did was try and make me scared of you.

I used to tremble every time you called my name. Every time I heard your footsteps in the house. Wondering all the time... what's Papa gonna say if I do this?... What's he gonna say if I do that?... What's he gonna say if I turn on the radio? And Mama, too... she tries... but she's scared of you. I don't know how she stand you... after what you did to her.

What you gonna do... give me a whupping? You can't whup me no more. You're too old. You're just an old man. You crazy. You know that? You just a crazy old man... talking about I got the devil in me. Come on... put me out. I ain't scared of you. Come on! Come on, put me out. What's the matter? You so bad... put me out! Come on! Come on!

The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Nighttime (Simon Stephens)

Christopher:

I remember the 20th of July 2008.

I was 9 years old. It was a Saturday. We were on holiday in Cornwall.

We were on the beach in a place called Polperro. Mother was wearing a pair of shorts made out of denim and a stripy blue swimming costume, and she was smoking cigarettes called Consulate, which were mint flavour. And she wasn't swimming.

She was sunbathing on a towel, which had red and purple stripes and she was reading a book by Georgette Heyer called the Masqueraders. And then she finished sunbathing and went into the water and said, "Bloody Nora it's cold." And she said I should come and swim too, but I didn't like swimming because I don't like taking my clothes off. And she said I should just roll my trousers up and walk into the water a little way. So I did.

And mother said, "Christopher! Look it's lovely." And she jumped backwards and disappeared under the water, and I thought a shark had eaten her and I thought a shark had eaten her and I screamed. And then she stood out of the water and came over to where I was standing and held up her right hand and spread out her fingers like a fan. "Come on Christopher, touch my hand. Come on now. Stop screaming. Touch my hand. Listen to me, Christopher. You can do it. It's OK Christopher. It's OK. There aren't any sharks in Cornwall."

Dana (*to the audience*) I can't remember the exact day I stopped speaking. Or even why. But I remember people's reactions.

They think I'm being difficult. Or shy. They don't get it. It's not a choice. It's not that I *won't* speak. I literally, physically *can't* speak. I get so anxious –

My throat tightens. I go hot. Palms sweat. Arms tingle. Words get trapped in my trachea. Face freezes. My heart beats out my chest. Everything sounds so far away.

And then I'm in the sea. Waves of panic overwhelming me. The land getting further and further away.

I try to catch a breath. But I can't. Everything's stuck.

I'm fifteen, and I speak to exactly the same number of people I spoke to when I was four. One. My mum. And as you can imagine, that's a double-edged sword. Two. Myself. Which is having a conversation with someone who gets me. Even if it's someone I don't always like.

The thing is – nobody wants to be different.

We pretend to celebrate difference, accommodate it. In reality, we just stick a label on it and put it in a kind of storage unit so it doesn't make the rest of the world look untidy – like my mum does with all her junk stuffed into the top drawer in the kitchen.

Let me show you the Calming Room. Also known as the De-escalation Room. The junk drawer of life. Also known as – The 'Freaks and Geeks' Room. (sarcastically) Great, isn't it?